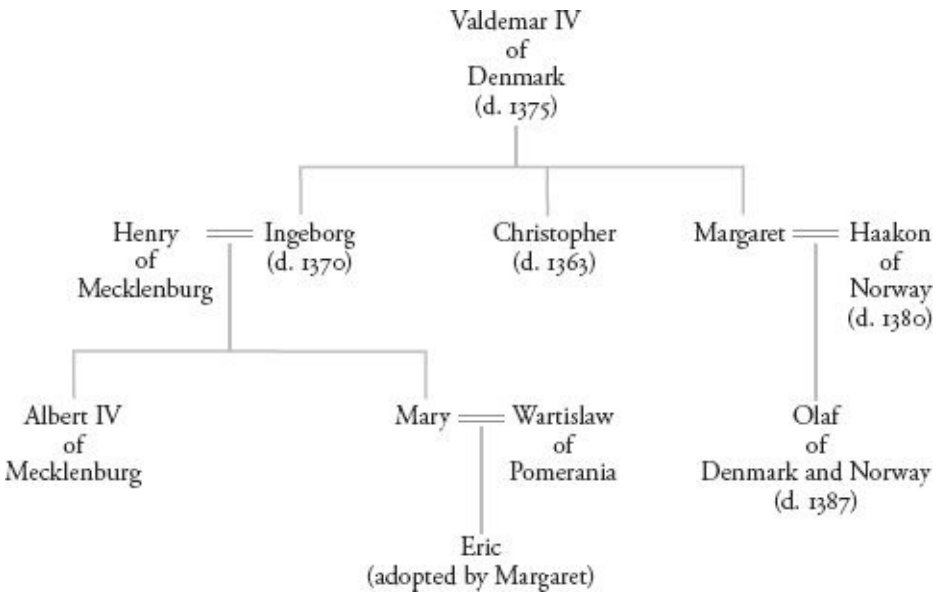
decide. To boost her claims there, Margaret adopted a son and heir: her dead older sister's grandson Eric, a child of five. The year after her recognition by the Danehof, Margaret was acclaimed as ruler of Norway as well.[2]

That left Sweden.

Albert of Sweden, brought to the throne by a majority of electors, had never gained the full allegiance of the noblemen in the west of his country. These men had preferred Magnus Ericsson; they had felt an affection for his son Haakon and grandson Olaf, and now were ready to offer their loyalty to Margaret. When Albert incautiously tried to commandeer noble-held lands and castles for his own use, their opposition to his rule crystallized.



86.1 Genealogy of Margaret and Eric.

A secret treaty, sworn out in January of 1388, promised Margaret the use of a series of castles and fortresses across Sweden, as well as recognition of the queen of Norway and regent of Denmark as "All-Powerful Lady and Rightful Mistress of Sweden." In exchange, Margaret pledged to protect "the rights, freedoms, and privileges" that the Swedish aristocrats had enjoyed "before King Albert came to Sweden"; even more important, she promised to restore to Sweden all lands that had been filched by Denmark and Norway over the past decades, returning the country to its old boundaries.[3]

Albert had nothing but scorn for his opponent, whom he nicknamed "Queen Breechless." But when Danish and Norse troops marched into Sweden, the country dissolved into civil war. "Ill stood the realm," a contemporary rhyming chronicle laments,